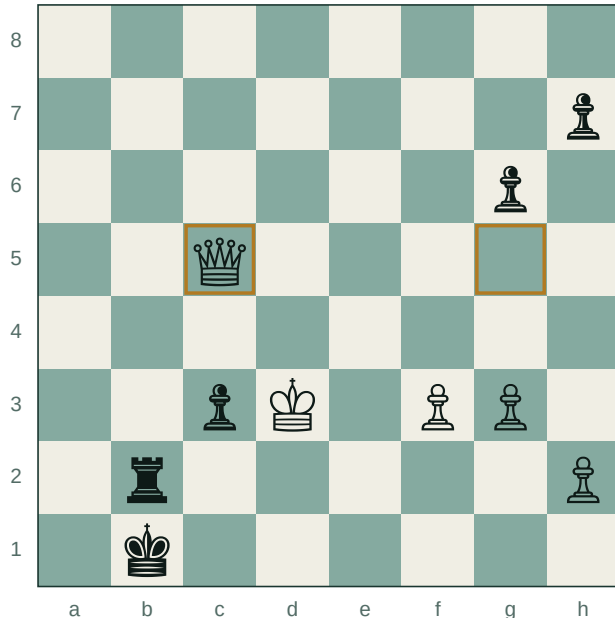


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 58

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 58.Qc5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

58...c2 59. Qxc2+ Rxc2

58...c2 The pawn moves from c3 to c2. Recorded reply: **59.Qxc2+**.

59...Rxc2 The rook captures the queen on c2.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from -4 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on d3. Geometrically undefended: queen on c5. Check for tactical protection.